Races of Hykaen

The various races on the continent of Sear-Ulf are as diverse as the nations and societies they occupy.

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Dwarves: The Dwarves of Sear-Ulf have their origin on the Lost Continent. The dwarves who today call Sear-Ulf home are principally the descendants of religious refugees, followers of The Broken Anvil who fled their homelands around seven hundred years ago. These weren't seafarers, and when they landed on the shores, they departed quickly to establish clanholds and enclaves in the hills and mountains of what would later become Antara, Ulfendon, and the southern edge of the Wildlands.

Subsequent years brought a variety of other dwarves to the continent - merchants, explorers, warriors, missionaries - who, for the most part, mingled with the humans and other races in the cities rather than establishing their own enclaves. These hold a variety of religious beliefs, from atheism to the Marengian Tricult to the veneration of the traditional Dwarven pantheon, but tend to remain staunch and stubborn in whatever beliefs they have adopted.

Today, this divide has been somewhat softened by the Ulfin conquest. While the Duke did not conquer the various clanholds of the mountain dwarves, he and his descendants consciously sought to open positive relations with them, and succeeded in establishing trade and cultural relations with the previously xenophobic holds. Both general lineages of dwarves share a language, preserved through a deep oral and written tradition, but the religious and physical divide split it into two dialects, known as Mountain Dwarven and Lowland Dwarven. The two are mutually intelligible, but barely, and misunderstandings are not uncommon.

A dwarven character will likely fall into one of these two broad categories. Was he raised in a clanhold, away from other races, or did he come of age in a city or town with constant exposure to other cultures, traditions, or languages? What is his relationship with the deeply conservative dwarven culture? Both the *Mountain Dwarf* and the *Hill Dwarf* subraces are acceptable for any dwarven character.

Dragonborn: Dragonborn are a rare sight throughout most of the continent, with the notable exception of the very southern nation of Korabath. Korabath was founded by colonists from the Old Continent nation of Drakora, which was a confederacy of human and dragonborn tribes who united under the rule of the warlord Fen Skurke, esteemed, “The Great”. Even today, though, dragonborn only make up around twenty percent of the population of Korabath, and much less everywhere else.

Throughout the continent, dragonborn share a tribal language known as Khadzish, which serves as a shared heritage connecting all of them to old Drakora.

A dragonborn character could come from Korabath, or could have grown up nearly anywhere else in the Southlands. There are strong communities in most Ulfin cities, though they tend to become rarer as one travels north. Regardless, a dragonborn typically knows her lineage by heart, and likely has several stories - exaggerated or not - to share about her ancestors. Is she still tied to her family and tribe, or has she found another cause to champion? Perhaps she is disillusioned by the imperfections she sees in the world, and has turned to leading an unsavory life?

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Elves: Elves, in all their diverse glory, are the second-most populous race in Sear-Ulf, primarily due to their large population base in the nation of Mansear. Their history begins with a tragedy, as events recorded only in myth lead to the near-genocide of the First Elves and the near-complete destruction of the Feywild, their native land. The only survivors of the event were a band of Winter Elves or Eladrin, who escaped and founded the nation of Jerisear in the far north of the Old Continent.

In subsequent centuries, these elves would colonize Sear-Ulf via the land bridge, pushing out the frost giants who roamed the forests and tundra and founding Mansear, the oldest nation of Sear-Ulf still in existence. The capital, Searan, is built around an old fey spring, and many of its residents have thus preserved strong fey features through the years. This old blood is represented by the *Winter Eladrin* subrace.

The other elves of the continent have developed different traits depending on their environment. For example, there are elves throughout Mansear that have a

strong affinity for arcane magic; these make up the majority of the faculty and students at Mansear's vaunted universities and schools of magic. They are also common at similar institutions in the Southlands, where their talent and expertise are in high demand. These are represented by the *High Elf* subrace.

There are also elf bands in forests across the entire continent. In the unbroken expanses of Mansear, these make up the bulk of the citizenry. In the Southlands, they are the caretakers and cultivators of their forests, and the chief providers of wood to other races. These are all represented in the *Wood Elf* subrace. Other bands, like the Errentei who live in the depths of the Sulessé jungles, reject associations with other races and live alone. These are colloquially known as "Wild Elves".

There is a younger lineage, which has grown up along with the cities which nurtured it. This is the *City Elf* subrace, representing those elves whose families have spent hundreds of years living in the cosmopolitan cities of the Southlands. They are cunning and sharp-witted, and have a reputation for being silver-tongued. Their features are given on a later page.

The elven mythos includes many references to a "Dark Elf" race, which was responsible, to one degree or another, for the chaos that caused the destruction of the Feywild. More superstitious elves believe that their shadowy kin are still about, and point to mysterious, unexplained incidents as their evidence.

An elven character could come from any of these lineages, but their outlook is likely to be highly informed by their background. Does your *High Elf* view herself as superior to all other races? Does your *Wood Elf* feel obligated to lecture anyone she sees practicing poor land husbandry? Is your *Winter Eladrin* prone to melancholy, and plagued by nightmares of the Feywild's destruction? Does your *City Elf* walk and speak with a swagger, or does he shrink from the spotlight and vanish into the crowd?

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Gnomes: Gnomes are eccentric nomads and wanderers. While the elven refugees established nations, the gnomes that escaped the destruction of the Feywild became a homeless people.

Some gnomes actively search for magic or technology that might allow them

to restore their ancient home, while others look for power to secure their own status in the uncertain world they find themselves in. Most gnomes have a very specific purpose for their wandering, though, and even those who choose to settle in one place will be frantically engaged in some project or cause.

Your gnome character should have such a purpose. Does he strive for the highest of arcane mastery, intending to restore the Feywild to its former glory? Does he steal from progressively more difficult marks, aiming to steal from a god? Does he care for orphans, to the point that he kidnaps children from abusive parents? Both the *Forest Gnome* and *Rock Gnome* subraces are appropriate for any gnome character.

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Half-Elves: Because of the close relationship between the Sær elves and the Duchy of Ulfendon, half-elves are common in both the Southlands and Mansear. In Mansear, they occupy a liminal social space. While most northern elves accept humans into their society, they have stereotypes and beliefs that often get projected onto the half-elves that live among them. Typically, half-elves with a *Wood Elf* parent are more common than *High Elf,* but half-elves are more common in Særan cities than the countryside.

In the Southlands, half-elves also occupy a liminal space, but the generally more cosmopolitan nature of the Southlands means that they typically aren't outcast. Their culture and beliefs often reflect one or both of their parents', but it's also not uncommon for them to consciously break from these. As a result, half-elves in the Southlands are as diverse or more as humans in the Southlands.

Half-Elf player characters are often strongly influenced by their life on the boundary of two cultures. Some half-elves choose to identify more strongly with one of their parent cultures, while others will reject both, and still others will synthesize the two into a uniquely half-elven outlook. Still others will tie their identities to clubs, cults, or nations whose bonds transcend race, like the nation of Antara.

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Halflings: Much like Gnomes, Halflings have no nation to their name. Unlike Gnomes, this isn't due to a lost homeland, but rather due to a tendency to simply live within

human society. The origins of their race are shrouded in myth and legend, but most of these tie the first halflings inextricably to the first humans.

Typically, one can find halflings anywhere one finds humans. They work, fight, and celebrate alongside them, and even intermarry. The children of these unions are either unusually short humans or unusually tall halflings; some scholars have postulated that this means halflings and humans are simply two different classifications of the same “species”, though this is hotly disputed by more conservative intellectuals.

As a result of their close ties to humans, halfling personalities and outlooks are just as diverse as human cultures and perspectives. When creating a halfling character, consider the land and culture he grew up in, but also how this proximity to humanity has affected him. Does he view humans with love or contempt? Does he struggle with feeling ignored by taller races? Does he see them as tall, clumsy, and graceless? Both the *Lightfoot Halfling* and *Stout Halfling* subraces are represented throughout the Southlands and are appropriate choices for characters.

Humans: Humans are undoubtedly the most diverse, numerous, and influential of all the races on Sear-Ulf.

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Half-Orcs: Half-Orcs are all but unknown on Sear-Ulf, as orcs are not native to the continent nor have they colonized any portion of it. Any half-orcs on the continent are recent transplants, since the time explorers began to rediscover the Old Continent.

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Tieflings:

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Goblins

New Subraces

City Elf

Ability Score Increase: Your Charisma score increases by 1.

City Elf Weapon Training: You have proficiency with the rapier.

Glib Tongue: You have proficiency in Persuasion; you also know the *vicious mockery* cantrip.

Wildlands Hobgoblin

Ability Score Increase: Your Constitution score increases by 2 and your Wisdom score increases by 1.

Beast Master: You have proficiency in Animal Handling

Tribal Vigor: When you are below one-half of your hit point maximum, you can use a bonus action to gain temporary hit points equal to your proficiency bonus plus your character level. Once you use this trait, you can't use it again until you finish a short or long rest.

Skilled Coordination: You can use a bonus action to Help an ally within 10 feet of you. You can use this ability a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus, and you regain all of these uses when you finish a long rest.

Southlands Hobgoblin

Ability Score Increase: Your Constitution score increases by 2 and your Intelligence score increases by 1.

Storyteller: You gain proficiency in History.

Unending Reserves: Your hitpoint maximum is increased by 1 and increases by 1 every time you gain a level.

Martial Fist: You have proficiency with unarmed strikes and improvised weapons. Your unarmed strikes deal 1d4 damage and count as weapons with finesse for the purpose of features that require weapons with finesse.

Bugbear